

bar-code scanners, and large-buttoned, voice-enabled MP3 players. Most of these devices are costly. The Ray smartphone is based on the Android operating system and is powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon processor.

According to Qualcomm, the Project Ray device combines the goodies of smartphone technology along with multiple specialty devices for the blind into one single, cost-effective handset with continuous mobile broadband connectivity. The user interface (UI) is designed for eye-free interaction. The project is being tested on around 100 participants across Israel.



Here comes NimbRo-OP, an open source robot!

Professor Sven Behnke and his team from the University of Bonn have come up with an open source robot named NimbRo-OP. Professor Behnke's team previously won the Louis Vuitton Cup for 'Best Humanoid' at RoboCup 2012.



This model is also based on the same NimbRo model but, this time, NimbRo-OP has got an attractive white head. NimbRo-OP is 95 cm tall (37.4 inches) and weighs 6.6 kg (14.55 pounds).

NimbRo-OP is powered by a dual-core AMD E-450 processor along with 2GB of RAM, and a 64 GB solidstate drive. The robot is armed with Wi-Fi, a wide-angled video camera (Logitech C905) and a Robotis CM-730 controller with a 3-axis accelerometer and a 3-axis gyro. The software is released under free and open licences. The GNU/Linux software is based on DARwin-OP. Those who are interested in the project can own a fully assembled robot from University of Bonn at an introductory price of 20,000 Euros plus taxes and shipping. The main reason for open sourcing this project is to enable other groups to use the robot, further improve it and take it to upcoming RoboCup events. The next RoboCup will happen in June 2013 in the Netherlands.

Meet Another Rival of Raspberry Pi

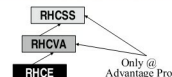
With the invention of Raspberry Pi, the stakes in the battle for supremacy in the small-sized computers space have gone up. One of the latest entrants in this area is Olimex, the Bulgarian device maker. The company has introduced the OLinuXino, a small single-board computer, which is totally open source. Olimex claims that this computer has a better processor and more built-in I/O ports as compared to Raspberry Pi.

The developers of the project say that the hardware and the software of the device are open source. This means that one can not only modify the software of the device but can also download the source files for the hardware. This can help in developing and selling your own products based on the design of the Olimex PC, which is available in two variants, both of which sell for less than \$60.

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